KOICA
People Peace Planet
Prosperity Partnership

UNDP

RU FEST

Recycling and Upcycling Fest

1-2 August 2025 | 16-17 Shrawan 2082 | Pokhara Event Center

Post Event Report

Table of Contents

- Executive Summary
- Objectives
- Event Overview
- Promotion & Outreach
  4.1 Digital Promotion
  4.2 Offline Promotion
- Venue Setup and Branding
- Program Highlights
- Merchandise & Recognition
- Event Management & Logistics
- Participation & Reach (To be completed with final data)
- Documentation & Media
- Financial Overview
- Outcomes & Impact
- Challenges & Learnings
- Conclusion

Executive Summary

The Recycling and Upcycling Fest 2025 (RU Fest) was successfully conducted at the Pokhara Event Center on 1–2 August 2025 under the GCRU Project with the support of UNDP Nepal. The event brought together entrepreneurs, innovators, policymakers, media, and the general public to celebrate sustainable practices, showcase green enterprises, and raise awareness on recycling and upcycling.

The Fest served as a flagship initiative in Gandaki Province to advance the circular economy, strengthen community engagement, and promote environmentally conscious behavior.

Objectives

The RU Fest 2025 was designed with the following objectives:

- To promote sustainable waste management through recycling and upcycling.
- To showcase eco-friendly enterprises and provide a marketplace for green entrepreneurs.
- To engage youth and communities through interactive workshops, games, and creative installations.
- To build awareness on circular economy principles, zero-waste lifestyle, and behavioral change.
- To facilitate networking among stakeholders: government, NGOs, private sector, and citizens.

Event Overview

Event Name:
Recycling and Upcycling Fest (RU Fest) 2025

Dates:
1–2 August 2025 (16–17 Shrawan 2082)

Venue:
Pokhara Event Center, Kaski

Audience:
Government officials, green entrepreneurs, students, media representatives, and the general public

Promotion & Outreach

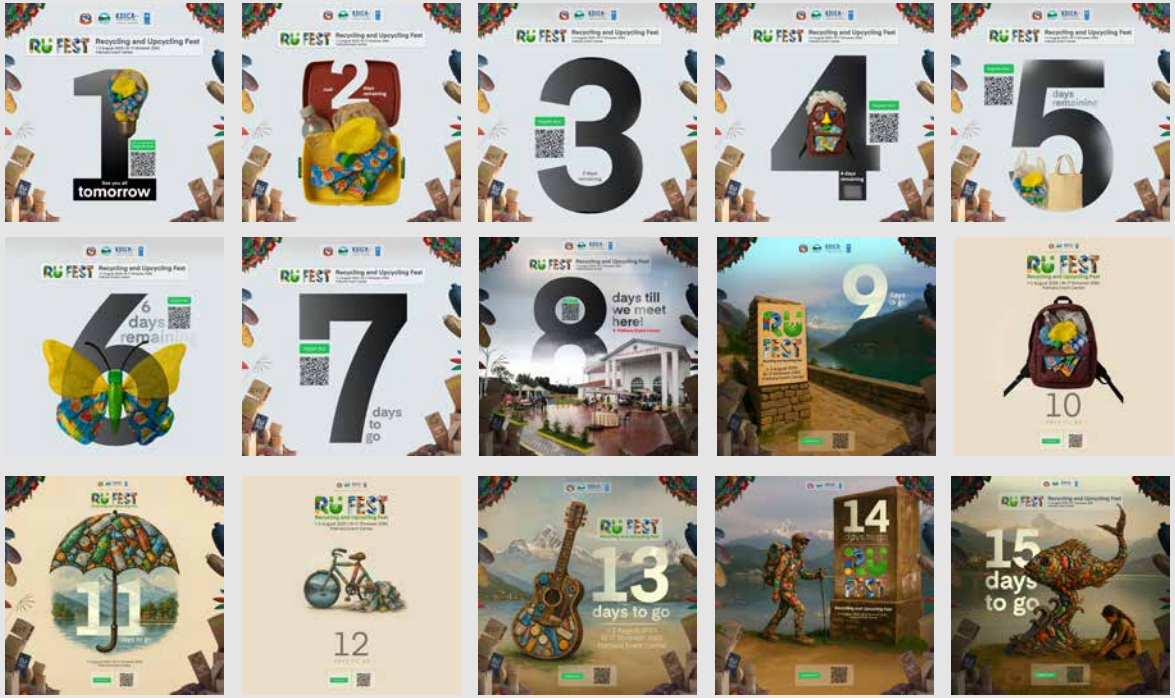
Digital Promotion

Influencer Reels: Reels were created in collaboration with local influencers.

Promotion & Outreach

Social Media Posts & Countdown Series:

Countdown graphic and carousel posts were published on Facebook, Instagram, and TikTok.



Promotion & Outreach

Mini documentaries Highlights

Mini-documentaries on local recycling and upcycling initiatives, each lasting 2–3 minutes, were produced.

Hamro Jiban Saili

Local women of Parvati Tole, Pokhara Metropolitan City–9, have successfully fostered entrepreneurship and created green jobs by upcycling old and discarded clothes. This initiative has been advanced with financial support from KOICA, technical assistance from UNDP, and coordination from Pokhara Metropolitan City under the project "Green Jobs Creation through Recycling & Upcycling (GCRU)".

Currently, 11 local women are directly employed through this enterprise operated by the Hamro Jivan Shaili Group. The group's eco-friendly, innovative, and socio-economically empowering work model will be showcased at RU Fest 2025.

Promotion & Outreach

Before 18 days

Website & Online Articles:

News Articles

News feature & coverage multiple posts leading up to event

GIF Ads

Live GIF placement on homepage carousel

पोखरामा हरित रोजगारी सिर्जना गर्दै GCRU परियोजना

पोखरा, कोरिया अन्तर्राष्ट्रिय सहयोग नियोग (KOICA) को आर्थिक सहयोग, संयुक्त राष्ट्रसंघीय विकास कार्यक्रम (UNDP) को प्राविधिक सहयोग र पोखरा महानगरपालिकाको सहकार्यमा पोखरा महानगरपालिकामा "रिसाइकलिङ र अपसाइकलिङमार्फत हरित रोजगारी सिर्जना...

आरयु फेस्टिभल सुरु, शनिबार पनि जारी रहने

पोखरामा पहिलो पटक आयोजना गरिएको दुई दिने आरयु फेस्टिभलमा शुक्रबार पहिलो दिन परियोजनाको बारेमा जानकारी, खेरा जाने सामानबाट बनेका सामाग्रीहरुको प्रदर्शनी तथा प्यानल छलफल लगायतका कार्यक्रम सम्पन्न भएको छ । पोखरा महानगरपालिकासँगको सहकार्यमा...

आरयु फेस्टिभलः शुक्रबार र शनिबार पोखरा ईभेन्ट सेन्टरमा

पोखरा, पोखरामा आजदेखि आरयु फेस्टिभल सुरु हुदैं छ । पोखरा महानगरपालिकासँगको सहकार्यमा कोरिया अन्तर्राष्ट्रिय सहयोग नियोग (कोइका) को आर्थिक सहयोग तथा संयुक्त राष्ट्र सङ्घीय विकास कार्यक्रम (युएनडिपी) को प्राविधिक सहयोगमा पोखरामा सञ्चालित...

पोखरामा श्रावण १६ र १७ गते आरयु फेष्ट हुदैं

पोखरा, पोखरामा पहिलो पटक आरयु फेष्ट हुने भएको छ । पोखरा महानगरपालिकासँगको सहकार्यमा कोरिया अन्तर्राष्ट्रिय सहयोग नियोग (कोइका) को आर्थिक सहयोग तथा संयुक्त राष्ट्र सङ्घीय विकास कार्यक्रम (युएनडिपी) को प्राविधिक सहयोगमा पोखरामा सञ्चालित...

Documentation & Media

Photography & Videography: Event covered with high-resolution photos, drone shots, and live coverage.

Highlight Video: Edited 3–5-minute event film (to be submitted separately).

Media Coverage: Press releases and articles published locally and nationally.

https://shorturl.at/19F36

Outcomes & Impact

Successfully demonstrated recycling and upcycling innovations to a diverse audience.
Provided market visibility to local and national eco-friendly enterprises.
Fostered community engagement through youth-centered activities and creative installations.
Promoted zero-waste practices in event management, aligning with GCRU objectives.
Strengthened stakeholder collaboration in advancing sustainability goals.

Challenges & Learnings

To be added: logistical challenges, audience management, or technical issues observed
To be added: recommendations for future editions of the Fest

Offline Promotion

LED Billboards at Prithivi Chowk and Pokhara Trade Mall:

Motion ads and graphics displayed at Prithvi Chowk and Trade Mall for 7 days.

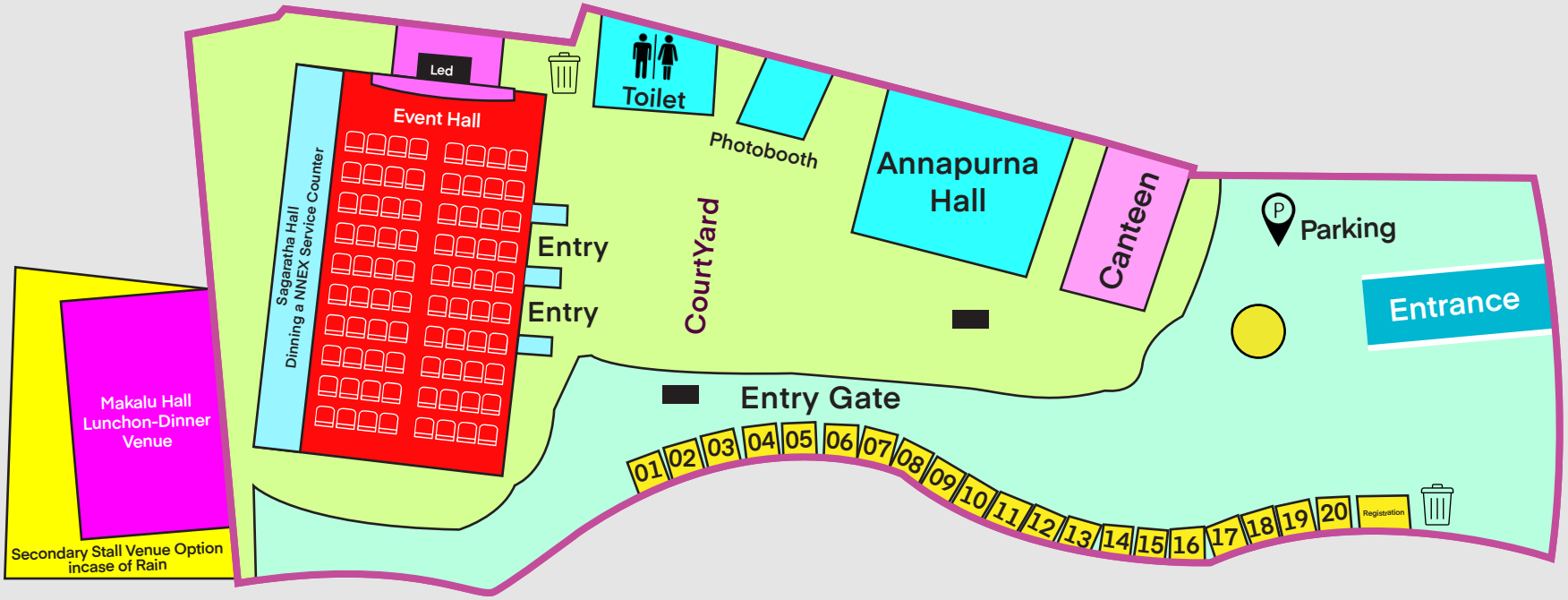
Digital LED Billboards:
In addition to traditional pole board placements, digital LED billboards were set up at Prithivi Chowk and Pokhara Trade Mall. These installations were uniquely designed using recycled and upcycled waste materials, symbolizing sustainable practices. The billboards served a dual purpose:

Event Promotion:
Displaying countdowns, highlights, and event branding to capture attention in high-traffic areas. Awareness Campaign: Educating the public on waste reduction, recycling, and eco-friendly lifestyle choices. This approach not only maximized visibility but also aligned the event's branding with its core environmental values.

Venue Setup and Branding

The Pokhara Event Center was transformed into a sustainability-themed venue, featuring:

27 exhibition stalls equipped with branding, power supply, and waste bins.



Venue Setup and Branding

Main Stage at Sagarmatha Hall

Venue Setup and Branding

Experience Zones:

Youth Games Arena, DIY Upcycling Tent, Compost Café, and Enterprise Market.

Venue Setup and Branding

Creative Installation:

The 6-foot “RU Bottle” art piece constructed from plastic bottles and caps, symbolizing reuse and circular economy.

Bottle Figure Installation: A large bottle-shaped structure was set up at Pokhara Metropolitan City office, symbolizing plastic waste transformation into art and awareness.

Fish Structure: Built entirely from discarded bottles and cans, this installation highlighted the pressing issue of plastic pollution in aquatic ecosystems.

Program Highlights

Opening Ceremony: Welcome remarks, keynote addresses, and cultural performance.
Exhibition Market: Local and national green enterprises displayed upcycled and recycled products.
Workshops & Demonstrations: Hands-on sessions on DIY upcycling, composting, and sustainable practices.
Youth Engagement: Eco-games, trivia contests, and interactive learning sessions.
Knowledge Sharing: A Korea-sharing program and panel discussions on green entrepreneurship.
Closing Session: Acknowledgments, token of love distribution, and certificate handovers.

Merchandise & Recognition

Branded ID cards and lanyards for different participant categories.
Crew T-shirts and caps promoting the Fest identity.
Certificates of Participation for panelists, exhibitors, and workshop hosts.
Eco-friendly tokens of love (upcycled combs, pots, coasters, paper products, etc.).

Event Management & Logistics

Hosts & Moderators: Ms. Salitaaj Kunwar (Host), Mr. Dipak Pariyar (Panel Moderator).

Audio-Visual Setup: Dual-hall sound systems, LED walls, projectors, and technical support teams.

Decoration: Natural floral arrangements and sustainable décor aligned with eco-conscious identity.

Waste Management: Segregated bins, compost labels, awareness posters, and volunteer-led cleanup shifts.

Participation & Reach

Total Attendees: 3000+

Number of Exhibitors: 28

Youth/Student Participation: 2100

Day 1

Organization Name	No. of People
SOS	80
Gogan Secendary School	55
Santi Nikunj	60
JCA	70
JHSS	26
Glolab Collegiate School	124
Kumdini Homes	53
Shree Metreri Ama Samuha	17
Pardi MA.VI	70
Mahira Swasthya Sevika	21
Shree Krishna School	40
Bhadrakali Mavi	31
WRC	28
River Dale School, Pokhara -16	11
Bindabasini Secondary School	44
Namuna Avasiya	10
Ward Member	8
Atithi Resort	8
DOKO Recycle	8
Gogan School	55
Patrakar Sangathan	4

Organization Name	No. of People
Santi Nikunja	60
PRMAS	8
ATBS	8
Manju Shree Group	9
TAAN Gandaki	3
UJWAL A.S	12
FCHV	22
Mahila Sip Bikash Samiti	25
Serchan Samuha	10
Total (Day 1)	980

Day 2

Organization Name	No. of People
Srijana Bording School	51
National Inucetive	48
G.B.S	29
Dinseny Land	50
Laxmi Avasiya S.	38
Sagarmath Boarding School	64
Total (Day 2)	280

Conclusion

The Recycling and Upcycling Fest 2025 proved to be a successful platform for advancing the circular economy agenda in Pokhara. By combining education, enterprise, and entertainment, the Fest inspired thousands to rethink waste, adopt sustainable practices, and support eco-entrepreneurship.

We thank UNDP Nepal and the GCRU Project for their trust and collaboration, and look forward to future opportunities to continue this impactful journey.

Annexes

Annex A: Event Schedule
Annex B: Stall Layout & Venue Map
Annex C: Media Coverage (Press, Online, TV)
Annex D: Photo Gallery
Annex E: Social Media Analytics

Venue Setup and Branding

The Pokhara Event Center was transformed into a sustainability-themed venue, featuring:
27 exhibition stalls equipped with branding, power supply, and waste bins.

Annex 1: Pre-Event Activities

Digital Promotion

Content Type	Link	Views
Reel	https://www.facebook.com/reel/542230732207374/	749K
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=997657015615427	270
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/o?v=628693286332741	1.5k
	https://www.facebook.com/reel/712552181404179	28.4k
	https://www.facebook.com/reel/4235350356786911	2.4k
	https://www.facebook.com/reel/1035211942142931	302.2K
	https://www.facebook.com/reel/732026805902615	586
	https://www.facebook.com/reel/663967793322925	4.8k
	https://www.facebook.com/reel/1046558861018244/	1.2k
	https://www.facebook.com/reel/1785728598688724/	253k
	https://www.facebook.com/reel/1049444384001334	1.4k
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=655540940888850	1k
	https://www.facebook.com/reel/1302836194560711	8.5k
	jhjj	270
	jhjj	1.5k
	jhjj	1.5k

Annex 1: Pre-Event Activities

Digital Promotion

Content Type	Link	Views
Shoutout	https://www.facebook.com/reel/710632168454631/	57.8k
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=2776342269422351	4.7k
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=2305622439854718	346
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=1641999736462545	286
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=607810372061235	108
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=607810372061235	108
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=2776342269422351	4.7k
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=1157228219757323	1.7k
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=700017346369321	436
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=697830236584935	269
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=930985235851598	1.1k
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=1069346015345781	95
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=629634079694538	246
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=1424176498862629	504
	jjjj	269

Annex 1: Pre-Event Activities

Digital Promotion

Content Type	Link	Views
Documentary	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=962685115935907	2.9k
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=632005282762390	2.6k
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=1653129115360517	2.8k
	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=797495399381785	432

Annex 3: Post Event Activities

Digital Promotion

Content Type	Link
Highlights Video	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=1443733043589983

Annex 3: Photos & Videos

Digital Promotion

Content Type	Link
Highlights Video	https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=1443733043589983
Day 1 Album	https://www.facebook.com/media/set/?set=a.1057599056561967&type=3
Day 2 Album	https://www.facebook.com/media/set/?set=a.1058277333160806&type=3

Annex 2: Countdown & Carousels

Digital Promotion

Content Type	Link
Countdown	https://www.facebook.com/photo.php?fbid=1046514974337042&set=pb.100069356465051.-2207520000&type=3
Countdown	https://www.facebook.com/photo.php?fbid=1043591154629424&set=pb.100069356465051.-2207520000&type=3
Post	https://www.facebook.com/photo.php?fbid=1044542254534314&set=pb.100069356465051.-2207520000&type=3
Carousel	https://www.facebook.com/photo.php?fbid=1041546901500516&set=pb.100069356465051.-2207520000&type=3
Carousel	https://www.facebook.com/photo.php?fbid=1040074178314455&set=pb.100069356465051.-2207520000&type=3
Carousel	https://www.facebook.com/photo.php?fbid=1040074164981123&set=pb.100069356465051.-2207520000&type=3

Annex 4: Public Queries & Feedback

Yasta massage Haru sarba sadharna dekhi dhandhya barga Haru samma puryauni atanta jaruri maninxa. feri Pani hernuhosa hamra nepalka karlaya haruma Pani yasta west Haru Ramro sang

Upayukta thauma puryaiko hundaina

Pdhai lekhaima matra simit xan tra

Jamma zero lebalma xa tesaile bhabisya chinta Jamal xa.

Sir ५ नम्बर वडा कार्यालय मा पनि आउनु पर्यो वडा अध्यक्ष सँग को क्लिप राख्न रिसाइक्लिंग अपसाईक्लिंग बारे

सर म पाँच नम्बर वडाको सहजकर्ता हो

भोली आउनु हुन्छ

How to participate as a volunteer?

How do I register?

Who's participating?

Congratulations for launching good project with a view to creating jobs,and helping to sustain environment for future generation!!

10:54 AM

When & where is the event?

When & where is the event?

How do I register?

Many thanks I am very happy proud of you all your team

how can schools participate at programme ?

can you please send itineraries of programme?

How do I register?

Who's participating?

When & where is the event?

When & where is the event?

वधाई छ मेयर साब !

Promotion & Outreach

Shout-out videos from the Mayor of Pokhara Metropolitan City and representatives of various organizations, extending greetings and support for the event.

धनराज आचार्य
मेयर, पोखरा महानगरपालिका

दिवस मान प्रधानाङ
वडा अध्यक्ष, पोखरा-२

नेत्र तिमिल्सना
फोकल पर्सन, हरित रोजगार सिर्जना कार्यक्रम

मोति तिमिल्सना
प्रवक्ता, पोखरा महानगरपालिका

विश्वराज आचार्य
अध्यक्ष, रेवान पोखरा

रुद्रनाथ बराल
वडा अध्यक्ष, पोखरा-८

राधिका शाही योगी
वडाअध्यक्ष, पोखरा-१७

Promotion & Outreach

Shout-out videos from the Mayor of Pokhara Metropolitan City and representatives of various organizations, extending greetings and support for the event.

राम बहादुर पौडेल
सामाजिक अभियान्ता

हेमप्रसाद आचार्य
प्रमुख प्रशासकिय अधिकृत, पोखरा महानगरपालिका

दिपेन्द्र मर्सानी
वडा अध्यक्ष, पोखरा-९

दिवश मान पद्यानाङ
वडा अध्यक्ष, पोखरा-२

Promotion & Outreach

Mini documentaries Highlights

Mini-documentaries on local recycling and upcycling initiatives, each lasting 2–3 minutes, were produced.

Pokhareli Sishakalam

Pokhreli Sishakalam is a community-led green enterprise based in Pokhara that transforms discarded newspapers into eco-friendly pencils. Established with the vision of contributing something meaningful to society, the initiative began in 2022 with support from UNDP, KOICA, and Pokhara Metropolitan City.

Through skill-based training facilitated by a master trainer from Ward No. 2, local women who were previously engaged only in household work have now found a new path of income generation and empowerment. Currently, around five women are directly engaged in the production process, creating pencils and other upcycled products from recycled paper.

Promotion & Outreach

Mini documentaries Highlights

Mini-documentaries on local recycling and upcycling initiatives, each lasting 2–3 minutes, were produced.

WSDO

Women's Skills Development Organization (WSDO) is a fair-trade, non-profit NGO based in Pokhara, Nepal. Since 1975, it has been empowering women—especially those who are economically disadvantaged, disabled, widowed, or marginalized—by providing them with training and sustainable employment opportunities. WSDO focuses on upcycling and recycling practices, turning waste materials such as discarded plastics, fabric scraps, and rice bags into eco-friendly handicrafts like woven bags, accessories, and household items. Through various training programs, WSDO has trained hundreds of women across different wards of Pokhara, equipping them with weaving, stitching, and crafting skills.

Promotion & Outreach

Mini documentaries Highlights

Mini-documentaries on local recycling and upcycling initiatives, each lasting 2–3 minutes, were produced.

Himalayan Life Plastic Pvt. Ltd.

Himalayan Life Plastics Pvt. Ltd. has been operating for over 12 years, collecting PET bottles and other plastic waste from across Nepal and processing them into granules. Recently, through a partnership with UNDP, the company has expanded into upcycling, transforming discarded plastic bottle caps into innovative products such as coasters, keyrings, and pots. Supported with machinery under the DCRU Project, the initiative has created direct employment for five people while promoting sustainable waste management and green entrepreneurship. The company regularly showcases its eco-friendly innovations at platforms like RU Fest.

Offline Promotion

Pole Boards & Gates:

50 pole boards were strategically placed across major city areas including Mahendra Pool, Newroad, and Lakeside.

Purpose: To increase awareness about the event, highlight key messages, and guide the public toward sustainable practices.

In addition, recycled and upcycled waste materials were innovatively used in LED billboards. These installations served dual purposes: promoting the event while spreading awareness about waste reduction and recycling.

Challenges & Learnings

Pole Boards and PET Bottle Promotion:
Explain where and how pole boards were placed, how the PET bottle installation was used for promotion, and why this was important for an event of this nature.

Venue Setup and Branding

Creative Installation:

Globe Structure (RU Project): A globe-shaped dome made of PET bottles showcased the global impact of waste and emphasized collective responsibility in tackling plastic pollution.

Placement Strategy:
Installed at Pokhara Metropolitan City office and other high-traffic public locations before the event. Relocated and displayed prominently at the event venue during RU Fest, becoming a centerpiece for photo opportunities and conversations.

Impact:
These creative installations served both as visual attractions and as educational tools, effectively engaging the community and reinforcing the event's sustainability theme.